Vol.03

GYC REPORT 2025

www.theglobalyouth.co

The year we became the Ocean

Reclaiming the Future,
One Act at a Time
December 2025 Edition



Global Youth Coalition

2025 REPORT

Our Mission in Motion



EMPOWERING YOUTH WORLDWIDE TO LEAD SYSTEMIC CHANGE FOR NATURE, CLIMATE, AND JUSTICE — WITH A FOCUS ON AI, CREATIVITY, AND NATURE-BASED SOLUTIONS.

WHAT'S NEXT?

FUTURES & SHELLS

OUR 2025 AT A GLANCE

2025 REPORT



30+

Delegations Mobilized
Represented in major events like SB60, FfD4, UNGA, and more.

120+

Partners and Institutions Collaborated

1M²

GYC now has a goal to protect 1 million square meters of land by 2026

Special Performance

1.5 MILLION CUMULAIVE OUTREACH

IN 2025, WE CELEBRATED THE EXPANSION OF GLOBAL PARTNERSHIPS! THE GLOBAL YOUTH COALITION BECAME UNMISTAKABLY PRESENT — FROM THE FORESTS OF BELÉM TO THE BLUE CORRIDORS OF UNOC IN NICE, FROM CIF TRUST MEETINGS IN D.C. TO COLLABORATION CARAVANS IN THE ITALIAN ALPS. WE DIDN'T JUST REPRESENT YOUTH — WE SHOWED WHAT CLIMATE DIPLOMACY LOOKS LIKE IN PRACTICE.

GLOBAL YOUTH CLIMATE TRAINING 2025 (GYCT)



130+ Countries • 27,000 Applicants • £36,000 bursaries

WE DIDN'T JUST BUILD A COURSE. WE IGNITED A MOVEMENT.

In a year defined by uncertainty, collective action became our anchor. The Global Youth Climate Training (GYCT) reached new frontiers in 2025. Bridging youth, science, and justice across 130+ countries and regions.

From urban centers to remote villages, over 27,000 young people applied, ready to engage in live, interactive sessions on climate finance, NDCs, justice, and more. Every module was designed to connect local realities with global systems, empowering learners to decode international policy and ignite action at home.

What began as an experiment between GYC and Oxford University now stands as one of the world's largest grassroots-led youth climate education programs. Our message was clear: no borders and no bureaucracy. Just bold, beautiful learning.



Awarded for heroic Zoom skills, unflappable calm, and always asking about the weather forecast. Together with Alexis McGivern and Clarissa Salmon.

Fred Davis
BROADCASTING IN-CHIEF



WHAT MAKES GYCT DIFFERENT?

60% alumni agreed that GYCT directly contributed to their success when engaging with international climate policy.

63% participants agreed that GYCT connected them with a community of international youth changemakers.

89% participants said GYCT increased their knowledge of international climate policy and UNFCCC

This was not just another training. GYCT has become a prototype for decentralized climate diplomacy, peer-led, justice-centered, and regionally grounded. As we prepared for COP30 in Belém, the seeds planted by our GYCT program were already blooming in local communities, councils, startup pitches, and peaceful uprisings around the world.

GYCT PARTICIPANTS

Our global cohort **2023-2025**



GYCT is a collaboration between the University of Oxford and the Global Youth Coalition.

- 5,400 youth trained through three full independent series
- £36,000 distributed in youth bursaries to enable equitable participation
- 100,000+ YouTube views from our global Zoom-to-YouTube broadcasts
- 65% of participants came from MAPA (Most Affected People and Areas)
- 21% of participants self-identified as Indigenous youth
- 6 languages offered in live interpretation to ensure inclusivity
- Top 3 countries: Nigeria (7.34%), Kenya (6.86%), Pakistan (5.56%)
- Demographics: 56% Women, 42% Men | Most participants aged 21-25

36K	100K+	6
pounds distributed in youth bursaries	YouTube viebs from our broadcast	languages live interpretation



Learn more in our IMPACT REPORT 2023 -2025

THE FORESIGHT RESEARCH:

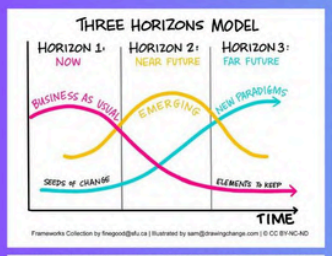
REWRITING THE FUTURES OF EQUITY, FAIRNESS AND JUSTICE

In a world where policy cycles move faster than planetary healing, 2025 marked a turning point: youth around the globe chose to look further. The Global Youth Coalition's Foresight Project brought together over 500 young people to redefine intergenerational equity — not as a buzzword, but as a measurable, justice-rooted principle.

We asked: What does fairness across generations really mean? How do we make sure decisions made today protect both the planet and generations to come? What tools can youth use to shift power, time, and imagination? How do we measure the progress towards the future that we want in the present?
https://theglobalyouth.co/Foresight-Research

Foresight Tool: Three Horizons (3H)

IE/IGF/IJ Research Project | Global Youth Coalition



Three Horizons Framework is a simple model for thinking about and discussing the future to guide meaningful action and navigate change by considering three different perspectives, or "horizons" at the same time.

Horizon 3: Visioning the Future
What would our food systems look like where intergenerational equity, sustainability, and sovereignty are present in our daily lives?
→ Values, power structures, and policy frameworks in a world beyond extractive industrial food systems.

Horizon 1: Mapping the Present
What's broken, unjust, or obsolete in today's food systems?
→ Corporate concentration, youth exclusion from food governance, unfair trade regimes, ecological degradation, food insecurity, and more.

Signals of Hope: Seeds of the Future
What emerging youth-led innovations, indigenous practices, policy experiments, and social movements already point toward transformative change?

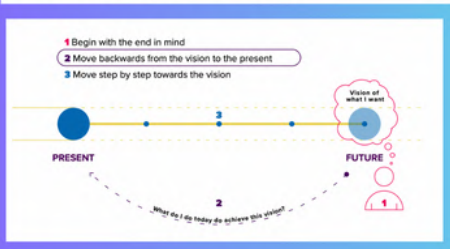
Horizon 2: Designing the Transition
What innovations, governance shifts, and alliances do we need to build the bridge from today's reality to the food systems of the future?

Actions:
Identify 5 actionable pathways and actor coalitions, with a focus on **youth leadership**, multistakeholder collaboration, and system redesign—not incremental reform.

Foresight Tool: Backcasting

IE/IGF/IJ Research Project | Global Youth Coalition

Backcasting is a foresight tool that starts with a desirable future and works backward to identify the specific steps, policies, and actions required to achieve it. Unlike forecasting, which extrapolates from current trends, backcasting focuses on building an actionable roadmap from a preferred future to the present.



Drivers and Future Signals of Change: Advocating for the Futures of intergenerational equity in governance systems

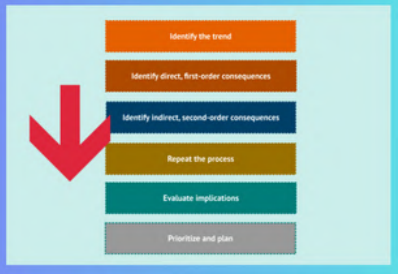
- Mainstreaming children and youth responsiveness measures in implementation of policies / country-level projects
- Mainstreaming Intergenerational Impact Assessments - pushing through a UN resolution on future generations
- Measuring intergenerational impacts in future VNRs, NDCs, BTRs, etc.
- New Intergenerational "SDGs 2.0" (after 2030)
- Second Global Stocktake that addresses the lack of responsiveness

Foresight Tool: Futures Wheels

IE/IGF/IJ Research Project | Global Youth Coalition

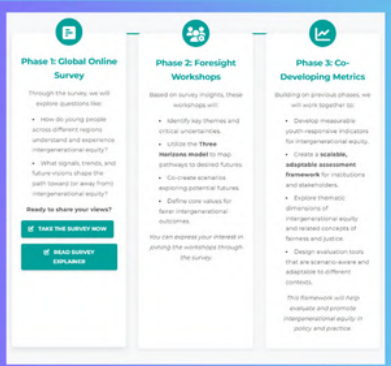


Futures Wheels is a foresight method to visualize the direct and indirect consequences of a specific trend, event, or decision. It uses a central concept with concentric circles representing primary, secondary, and tertiary impacts, helping individuals and organizations understand causal relationships, identify potential risks and opportunities, and foster proactive decision-making.



How: 3 phases

IE/IGF/IJ Research Project | Global Youth Coalition



What:

IE/IGF/IJ Research Project | Global Youth Coalition

Understanding youth's definition of what accounts as progress on Intergenerational equity, fairness, solidarity & justice



- Imagining the thematic desired futures
- Identifying signals and drivers of change, roadmap of possible actions
- Defining youth responsiveness metrics for intergenerational equity

IE / IGF/IJ Research Project

FORESIGHT

Snapshots of Engagement in 2025:



Workshop on the Futures of Nature, Loss and Damage, Energy Transition at COY20



Roundtable on the Futures of the GYCT and Climate Education at COP30



Side Event at COP30



Project was selected for the NGFP 2026 Fellowship and attended the Dubai Future Forum



Session on Intergenerational Equity ACUNS 2025 Annual Meeting



Workshops Contributing to Youth Lead WPAY Submissions



Dialogues Contributing to Youth Lead WPAY Submissions



Foresight Workshop at the first FfD Children and Youth Conference, Sevilla


THEGLOBALYOUTHCOALITION
LEGACY FOR TOMORROW
INCUBATED CONCEPTS
EMERGING FORESIGHT VENTURE
BRIDGETOWN
AMSTERDAM
MUSANDAM
HONG KONG
ANTALYA
OSLO
Futures
&
Shells
IMAGINATE SOLUTIONS
2026-2027

THE TRIDENT 20+10

Our plans adapted to cross the Ocean — From the spirit of the sea to the roots of the Amazon: our journey transcended borders and fulfilled a deeper mission.

✦ WHAT WAS THE TRIDENT 20+10?

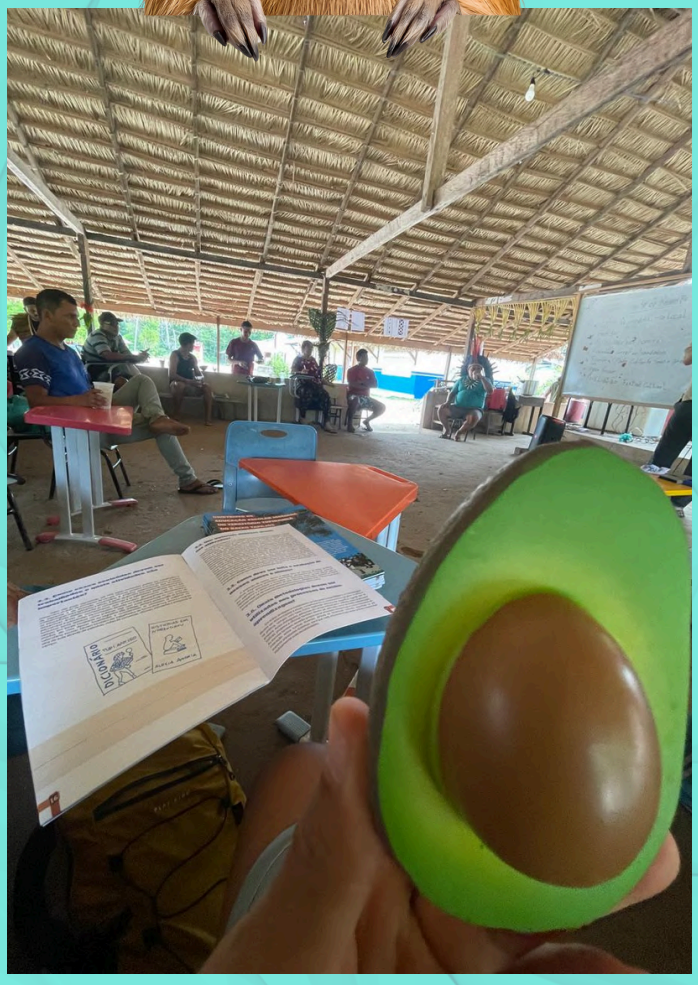
2025 marked the 20th anniversary of the Kyoto Protocol's entry into force and the 10th anniversary of the Paris Agreement, two key climate milestones. Our plan was bold: sail across the Atlantic, from Europe to Brazil, carrying youth leaders, scientists, and artists on a symbolic journey of climate unity, diplomacy, and foresight: The Trident 20+10.
But plans had to evolve. Storms shifted. And so did our path.



RIO TAPAJOS



The Infinity crew together with the Cacique and doña Maria Tupinamba, a legendary woman involved in the process of demarcation of her territories.



AF Pre- COP30 Workshop in Conselho de lideranças das aldeias tupinambas

We made it to COP30 in Belém, not by ocean waves, but by the waves of commitment that surged across jungles, riverbanks, youth forums, and policy rooms. The Trident did not sink, it shifted course to rise stronger. Days before we crossed the Atlantic, our plans changed due to the lack of funding. We end up navigating 2000 miles through the Amazon realities. Making our expedition even more significant.

The Avocado Framework and the Amazon blended seamlessly. As we walked under her trees, we didn't just share the AF, we planted it.

From Ecuador, Australia, USA, Netherlands, Germany, and Myanmar, to the vibrant heart of Brazil. This mission united changemakers from various corners of the world, sharing and crafting stories as we moved.
Together, we made the Trident 20+10 more than a voyage. We made it a movement.



INFINITY CREW AT TUPINAMBA TERRITORIES



GYC SHARING HOW TO USE A DRONE TO COMMUNITY YOUNGSTERS



AF WORKSHOP AT SAO DOMINGOS COMMUNITY

ACTIONS OVER WORDS

The Trident is not a route, It is a MINDSET

2025 reminded us that movement is not always linear, and victory is not always loud. Sometimes, it's the silent docking in a forgotten harbor. The whispered agreement among strangers who now call themselves comrades.
We reclaimed the narrative. And now, we sail forward together.

What did we deliver?

- The Avocado Framework, our intergenerational tool for climate policy and justice, was hand-delivered to key parties in Belém after being discussed in over a dozen countries throughout 2025.
- We established live training exchanges in riverside Amazon communities, linking global youth to biocultural corridors and new local knowledge holders.
- We proved that adaptability is strategy. The Trident didn't fail, it morphed into something even more powerful: a living myth that continues into 2026.

Who joined the mission?

The Trident grew stronger and richer as new crew members came aboard, not because they were invited, but because the journey spoke to their soul.
GYC's journey on the boat started October 3rd in Alter do Chão, 1,200+ kilometers from Belém and weeks later when the boat returned for COP30 Paulo and Nay Chi joined our mission:

- Paulo Tupinambá — An Indigenous leader from Brazil who, despite political tensions and internal resistance, chose to represent his people in the UN space. He joined the sailing team in spirit and action, bringing with him ancestral wisdom, resilience, and a clear voice to COP30.
- Nay Chi — A refugee and videographer from Myanmar who found in GYC and this journey a space to boost her advocacy. She documented, reflected, and amplified voices from the margins to the world stage — offering not just coverage, but a counter-narrative of hope.

As the Global Youth Coalition (GYC) continues to scale youth-driven environmental action, we are pioneering new tools for measurable planetary protection. Through our collaboration with UON.Earth, each square meter of already demarcated, protected land can be tokenized into a verifiable digital unit — 1 m^2 per token. This system ensures funds go directly to the grassroots communities and custodians who care for these ecosystems. UON can only support registered NGOs and legally demarcated conservation territories, making it essential that youth actions align with these legal and geographic frameworks. GYC's role is to bridge the gap between grassroots action, youth energy, and institutional support by ensuring all land and partners meet these criteria.

By integrating the UON system into our ecosystem of impactful partnerships, we enable youth-led projects, such as the "1 Million Square Meters" campaign, to scale transparently, accountably, and legally. Youth can fundraise, activate, and report impact not just in stories or images, but in traceable, tokenized land conservation units that satisfy due diligence requirements of international donors and legal entities. Through this partnership, GYC is transforming climate storytelling into quantifiable land justice, empowering a new generation to defend nature one verified meter at a time.

SPECIAL THANKS TO:

UNION OF NATURE
FOUNDATION





YOUTH GALA | BELEM, BRASIL



THE CYCLE OF WATER

Why it matters:

- Glacier loss is accelerating globally; 2023 set a record for annual melt. AP News
- Peru (Andes): National glacier area dropped from ~2,041.85 km² (1955–62) to ~1,118.11 km² (2016).
- Why it matters: Melt changes water availability and increases disaster risk (floods, landslides) , the "water cycle" becomes a governance issue, not a nature documentary. Reuters+1

Mountains, glaciers, rivers, oceans are all one system. Throughout 2025 GYC continued to show up where action is demanded. This year we found ourselves in the Tapajós and the Amazon's living arteries, to the high-altitude frontlines of the Alps and the Andes. The shifts in balance of the mountains, glaciers, rivers, and oceans require us to adapt and be in motion alongside them.

Glaciers aren't "pretty backdrops." They are water towers in motion — sliding centimeters per day — and while yes, they've melted, the rate at which they do is no longer natural. Human-driven warming is accelerating the loss, shifting river timing, threatening dry-season supply, and amplifying hazards downstream.

That's why our work can't romanticize the ocean while ignoring the ice upstream, or talk about "nature" while staying silent on extraction. Mining on land and at sea breaks the water cycle in different ways, but the logic is the same: take now, externalize later. In the Amazon, we saw how industrial footprints and river health collide in real time; in the mountains, we saw how meltwater becomes a measure of risk, grief, and adaptation. The agenda is not "youth vs. adults." It's humans-with nature, across generations, learning how to live alongside the system we depend on.

Science, in one punchy reality check: global mountain glacier melt is accelerating, with over 7 trillion tons lost since 2000, and a record 604 billion tons lost in 2023. AP News
And in Peru alone, official national inventories show glacier area falling from ~2,041.85 km² (1955-62) to ~1,118.11 km² (2016), a steep decline in a country where glacier-fed water matters for cities, agriculture, and ecosystems.







GYC AT UNOC SPECIAL EVENT



Water is not just around us, it *is* us. Every body is a moving river: we drink roughly 2–3 liters a day, we eat water embedded in food, and we depend on invisible flows that cool our data centers, wash our minerals, and power our cities. Yet the imbalance is stark: agriculture takes the lion's share of freshwater, mining diverts and contaminates entire watersheds, and our technologies sip constantly from aquifers we rarely see. Youth feel this contradiction viscerally. We hydrate between sessions, refill bottles at protests, cross rivers to reach conferences, and learn, sometimes painfully, that access to water is access to dignity. Water teaches us love because it connects everything it touches. When it's scarce, conflict follows; when it's shared, trust grows. To care for the water is to care for one another.



This is where youth energy becomes water energy.
We move like rain, falling into rooms, streets, workshops, and negotiations, then gathering into currents strong enough to reshape ground. Watch ants in a storm: they don't wait for orders; they form living rafts, each body protecting the whole. The queen isn't a ruler, she's a source of life, and the system survives because every role matters, that's our cue. Collaboration over heroics. Care over extraction. As humanity reaches for space, we must not repeat Icarus' mistake and forget the source that keeps us alive. Our role is to protect the cycle that protects us. To learn from water: to be adaptive, collective, patient, and unstoppable. Shaping ourselves together until the future can drink safely from the world we pass on.



WE ARE ONE

COP30 did not begin for the Global Youth Coalition inside the Blue Zone. It began upriver.





BELEM COP30: FROM TERRITORIES TO NEGOTIATION TABLES

Before badges, before panels, before speeches, GYC arrived in the Amazon by water. Navigating the Tapajós and Amazon rivers, engaging with Indigenous and riverside communities whose lives are directly shaped by the decisions debated in conference halls. From Tupinambá territory to Munduruku and São Domingos communities, youth delegates witnessed the realities of land, water, extraction, and governance firsthand.



Arriving in Belém by river reframed everything. Climate negotiations stopped being abstract. Loss and Damage had faces. Nature-based Solutions had names. Clean energy debates met real lived experiences. The Amazon was not a backdrop to COP30, it was the starting point. This grounding shaped GYC's presence throughout the summit: youth not as symbolic observers, but as actors carrying territorial knowledge into high level political spaces like COP.

Navigating the journey from the ground up, helped to shape our understanding of whats going on. COP30 demands actions align with priorities on the ground. GYC chose to start there.

Once we arrived a key milestone was the formal delivery of the GYCT Report to the Chair of the African Group of Negotiators (AGN), reinforcing youth capacity not as advocacy alone, but as informed participation in multilateral processes.

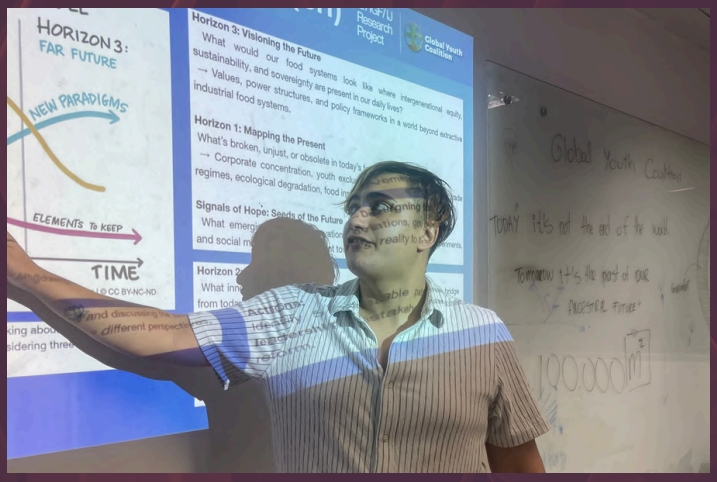
GYC and Global Youth Climate Training (GYCT) alumni **followed negotiations across adaptation, finance, Loss & Damage, and just transition tracks.** Youth delegates were not only attending events, they were tracking text, engaging negotiators, facilitating conversations, and translating policy into action.

Throughout COP30, **the Avocado Framework was used as a practical lens in workshops and side events.** We connected:

- Nature-Based Solutions with land governance and Indigenous stewardship
- Clean Energy Transition with youth jobs and access
- Loss & Damage with frontline realities and accountability

This was not policy theater. We tested a framework in real time.
High-level exchanges, including 1:1 dialogues with heads of state representatives, UN leadership, and national delegations were approached not as photo opportunities, but as strategic conversations anchored in implementation pathways.

**AT COP30, GYC DEMONSTRATED SOMETHING SIMPLE YET RARE:
YOUTH CAN OPERATE INSIDE THE SYSTEM WITHOUT LOSING INTEGRITY.**







Beyond the venues, GYC supported awareness actions, workshops, foresight sessions, and peaceful mobilizations: reinforcing that climate diplomacy extends far beyond official rooms.

AVOCADO FRAMEWORK IN ACTION

Relationships secured. Frameworks tested. Youth positioned not just for the next COP, but for the long work between them.



Nature Based Solutions

- "Territory → governance": we went to the source.
- "Indigenous stewardship centered": partnerships + recognition moments and PR.
- "Implementation pathway": what Parties/funders can fund/do next (benchmark-ready actions)

Clean Just Energy Transition

- "People-first transition": energy access, youth jobs, just transition lens
- From text → practice: negotiations tracked, insights translated for youth
- Implementation focus: what funders & Parties can actually support next





Loss and Damage

- Frontline communities in the room: river & territory realities brought into COP
- Accountability lens: linking impacts to responsibility & response
- Beyond statements: pathways for action, not just recognition

250

youth supported to access the COP30 universe

What it took to be there?

**From the Tapajós to the Blue Zone,
a sailboat, a house, and a youth network.
Eight weeks of continuous presence.
Participation designed with intention.**



RESILIENCE AND COMMITMENT

GYC co-hosted cultural and youth-led spaces, including a Latino youth gathering and a Youth Gala, where alliances were built across regions, movements, and disciplines. These moments mattered. They created opportunities to build trust, momentum, and shared direction beyond formal negotiations.
Indigenous leadership remained central to our approach. Together with partners such as SustainUS, GYC supported Indigenous communities following key COP breakthroughs, sharing resources, and weaving our networks. Our collaborations affirm that progress is collective and never extractive.

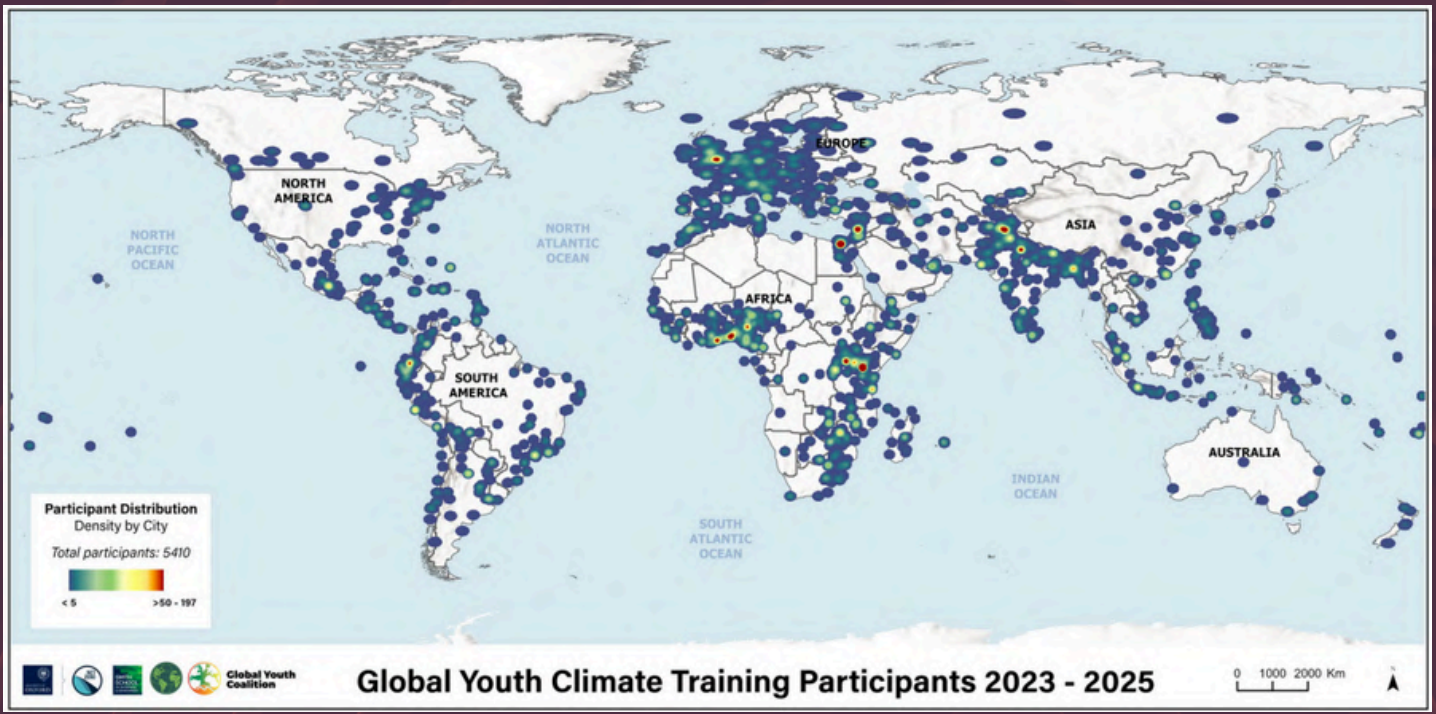
Capacity building proved cumulative. GYCT bursary recipients and alumni were present across COP30, hosting their own sessions, supporting partner initiatives, and engaging inside and outside UN spaces. Trained youth did not wait for permission to lead; they acted.

At the same time, GYC practiced an intergenerational approach. Paulo Tupinambá became one of the first members of the AF40 support circle: a space for experienced leaders beyond traditional "youth" categories who actively stand with emerging generations. Because this work is not about age. It is about responsibility, lived experience, and alignment with nature. The new twenties are not an age bracket. They are a mindset.

Beyond the venues, GYC supported awareness actions, foresight workshops, and peaceful mobilizations, reinforcing that climate diplomacy does not live only in negotiation rooms, but in relationships, territories, and shared futures.



Paulo Tupinambá entered the Blue Zone for the first time — and within minutes crossed paths with Sonia Guajajara, Brazil's Minister of Indigenous Peoples. A quiet victory: from territory to negotiations, made possible through the collective work of GYC and SustainUS



Tree Roadmap

A phased pathway turning experimentation into durable systems, from pilots to scalable, youth-led infrastructure.

FRÜTZ — Play the Future

A social AR experience turning cities into playable ecosystems. By prioritizing connection and fun, it unlocks high engagement while aligning participation with measurable sustainability outcomes

Foresight Project

A structured offering emerging from GYC practice: future thinking and scenario design for education, institutions, and mission-aligned partners, delivered through playful yet rigorous methodologies that break silos.

Futures & Shells (Pilot) — In-Person Activation

An immersive format blending foresight, culture, and strategy: 3 days · 6 locations · 9 futures. Youth leaders work alongside policymakers, educators, investors, and innovators to rehearse transitions before they unfold.

Avocado Framework → UNFCCC

Positioning AF as a youth-led implementation accelerator across Nature-Based Solutions, Clean Energy Transition, and Loss & Damage, moving from advocacy into recognized policy architecture.

GYCT — RELOADED

Scaling Global Youth Climate Training with advanced tracks, alumni pathways, and stronger bridges into negotiations, finance, and on-the-ground implementation.

Sustainable Finance Layer for Champs

A cooperative funding coordination layer, not speculative finance, designed to align diverse funding sources behind youth-led action. It blends mission-linked revenues, grants, and partner contributions, and connects them to projects aligned with Avocado Framework benchmarks. Governance prioritizes transparency, shared oversight, and peer accountability, allowing the model to evolve as long-term partners and capital pathways mature.

FUTURES: 2026 & BEYOND


FOSSIL OF THE DAY AWARD
COP
UNITED NATIONS
OCEAN CONFERENCE
NICE, FRANCE 2025
EL SALVADOR


POLLUTERS' CLIMATE BILL
COP30: ACT FOR
BRASIL
Climate Mobility Pavilion
REWORLD
OR
REPEAT?

Jump

With us





Global Youth Coalition


m²
SUPPORT US
PH: ALFONSO JIMENEZ